

040. Chapter 3 Verses 38-39

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

VERSE 3.38

धूमेनाव्रियते वह्निर्यथादर्शो मलेन च ।
यथोल्बेनावृतो गर्भस्तथा तेनेदमावृतम् ॥ 38 ॥

dhūmenāvriyate vahniry
athādarśo malena ca |
yatholbenāvṛto garbhas
tathā tenedamāvṛtam ||

◆ dhūmena – by smoke; āvriyate – is covered; vahnir – fire; yathā – as; ◆
ādarśaḥ – mirror; malena – by dust/dirt; ca – and; ◆ yathā – as; ulbena – by the
amnion (membrane); āvṛtaḥ – covered; garbhaḥ – embryo; ◆ tathā – so; tenā –
by that (desire); idam – this (wisdom); āvṛtam – is covered.

**As fire is enveloped by smoke, as a mirror by dust, as an
embryo by the amnion, so this knowledge of the Self is
enveloped by Kama and Krodha.**

VERSE 3.39

आवृतं ज्ञानमेतेन ज्ञानिनो नित्यवैरिणा ।
कामरूपेण कौन्तेय दुष्पूरेणानलेन च ॥ 39 ॥

- ◆ āvṛtaṃ jñānametena
- ◆ jñānino nityavairiṇā |
- ◆ kāmarūpeṇa kaunteya
- ◆ duṣpūreṇānalena ca ||

āvṛtaṃ – covered; jñānam – knowledge; etena – by this; jñāninaḥ – of the wise;
nitya-vairiṇā – by the eternal enemy; kāma-rūpeṇa – in the form of desire;
kaunteya – O son of Kunti; duṣpūreṇa – insatiable; analena – fire; **ca** – **and**. **cha**
—and

**O Arjuna! Knowledge of the Self is covered by this
everlasting foe of the wise in the form of desire, insatiable
like fire.**